



Valentina Marino

*Experience Strategist
& Creative Technologist*

Creative Product Developer & Design Engineer with 6+ years across digital and physical products. I design and build experiences from concept to implementation, blending UX research, design systems, and frontend development, across music, fashion, consumer tech, and smart-home products. I believe that technology is most powerful when it serves human connection, cultural identity, and felt experience.

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Work Experience

Oct 2025 – present
Amsterdam, NL - remote



Creative Director & Strategist – Independent

Carmela Collective *(Cultural Platform)*

React Typescript NextJS GraphQL TailwindCSS CraftCMS Figma

- Co-founded Carmela Collective, a Latin American music and culture platform in Amsterdam, leading brand identity, digital strategy, and build the entire web ecosystem.
- Consulting for Qommunity (Belgium) on web strategy and digital presence, translating organisational mission into coherent user experience and content architecture.
- Developing valmar.studio as an independent creative and research practice at the intersection of cultural strategy, sensory design, and technology.

Sept 2023 – Sept 2025
Amsterdam, NL - hybrid



React Front-End Developer

Bravoure *(Digital Agency Product & Estrategy)*

React Typescript NextJS REST API GraphQL Git TailwindCSS CraftCMS

- Contributed to the development of multiple digital products across education, media streaming, and cultural platforms, collaborating closely with designers, PMs, and stakeholders.
- Helped translate product requirements and user needs into scalable frontend architectures and reusable design systems.
- Participated in defining UI patterns, accessibility standards, and responsive behaviors across platforms.
- Migrated products to TypeScript to improve long-term maintainability and product scalability.
- Balanced delivery speed with UX consistency and performance considerations.

May 2022 – Aug 2023
Amsterdam, NL - hybrid



React Front-End Developer

Autofill Technologies *(AI automated technologies - hybrid)*

React Typescript NextJS REST API Figma Git

- Worked on a B2B SaaS product, contributing to the evolution of the customer dashboard experience.
- Collaborated with UX designers and product stakeholders to implement product improvements based on user feedback.
- Designed and built reusable components supporting consistency and scalability across the product.
- Optimized performance and interaction flows to support complex data-driven use cases.

Sept 2021 – April 2022
Amsterdam, NL - hybrid



Web Developer (intern)

Routinely *(E-commerce skincare - on site)*

React Typescript NextJS REST API TailwindCSS

- Supported the development of a consumer e-commerce product, implementing responsive interfaces aligned with brand and usability goals.
- Integrated CMS and REST APIs to support dynamic content and product scalability.
- Contributed to codebase refactoring (JavaScript → TypeScript), improving long-term product stability.

Jan 2020 – Nov 2020
Amsterdam, NL - hybrid



Creative Researcher

Random Studio *(Creative Agency - hybrid)*

Adobe Suite

- Conducted creative and cultural research to inform physical-digital experiences.
- Translated abstract cultural insights into concept briefs and experiential design directions.
- Collaborated on installations combining physical space, narrative, and digital interaction.

June 2018 – Apr 2019
Eindhoven, NL - hybrid



Qualitative UX Researcher & Design Strategist (project)

Signify - Philips Lighting *(Consumer products - on site)*

Figma Adobe Suite

- Developed “Value Tuning”, a qualitative UX research methodology to understand how physical product attributes shape perceived value and brand meaning.
- Led end-to-end user research for physical smart-home products, from methodology design to insight synthesis.
- Explored sensorial perception, materiality, and psychological value in domestic objects.
- Produced actionable insights to guide material, form, and quality decisions for future product development.
- Positioned products within a competitive landscape (Apple, IKEA, Google Home) based on lived user perception rather than features alone.

Education

Jan 2021 – Aug 2021

Digital Society School

Digital Transformation | Traineeship

Nov 2020 – Nov 2021

SheCodes

Software Engineering | License

Sept 2015 – Jun 2019

Design Academy Eindhoven

Industrial Design | Bachelor

Sept 2013 – Jun 2015

Haute École des Arts du Rhin

Applied Arts | Bachelor

Languages

- English (Professional)
- Spanish (Native)
- French (Professional)
- Portuguese (Advanced)
- Dutch (Basic)

Skills

Product & Research

- Product Discovery & Ideation
- Qualitative UX Research
- User Journeys & Experience Mapping
- Concept Development
- Design Systems

Design

- Figma
- Interaction Design
- Visual & Sensory Design
- Design Thinking

Development

- React, Next.js, TypeScript
- REST & GraphQL APIs
- Frontend Architecture
- Performance Optimization

Tools

- Figma, Git, CraftCMS
- TailwindCSS, ShadCN
- Adobe Suite
- Three.js / GLSL / Blender

Mentions

Melkgweg Design Awards 2019

(Nominee to the highest original project)

Rare Talents Scholarship

2015 – 2019

Areas of Expertise & Potential

I work at the intersection of design, technology, and cultural research, acting as a bridge between the abstract and the concrete. My practice seeks to understand how people relate to objects, interfaces, and systems in order to guide design and implementation decisions, transforming these relationships into meaningful experiences.

Cultural research and conceptual translation

My approach begins with qualitative and cultural investigation. I analyze behaviors, narratives, and contexts to identify subtle meanings that influence how products are perceived and valued. From these insights, I develop concepts and design directions that guide strategic and project decisions.

Materialization through design and technology

I have a strong ability to transform abstract ideas into concrete and implementable solutions. I work from concept to implementation, integrating experience design and frontend development, understanding code, narrative, and interface as parts of the same system.

Multicultural trajectory and purpose

My background and lived experience across Colombia, France, and the Netherlands directly shape how I think and design. I am particularly interested in projects that use technology consciously, seeking to generate positive impact, collective value, and new ways of relating between people and systems.